



M I N D A N C H O R

by Jai

T O O L K I T 0 5

The Proximity Tax Calculator

Quantify the cost. Claim back the future.

A High-Virality Diagnostic Asset

Calculate the real cost of your emotional avoidance — in opportunity, relationship, ego, and strategic range.

THE CORE CONCEPT

What is the Proximity Tax?

The Proximity Tax is the hidden strategic cost you pay every time emotional discomfort overrides strategic judgment.

It is not paid in one dramatic decision. It is paid in thousands of micro-decisions — the avoided room, the delayed conversation, the rejected opportunity, the restructured team — each one extracting a small toll that accumulates invisibly until the bill becomes unpayable.

"Every avoidance pattern has an invoice attached to it. Most people never open the envelope."

This calculator helps you open the envelope.

It is organized into five tax categories, each representing a domain where emotional avoidance extracts real strategic cost:

- Opportunity Cost Tax — value lost through avoidance-driven rejection of opportunities
- Relationship Cost Tax — network, leverage, and access surrendered through withdrawal
- Ego Cost Tax — the compounding price of protecting status over strategic positioning
- Withdrawal Consequence Tax — the operational and reputational cost of exits
- Strategic Range Tax — contraction of freedom, possibility, and movement over time

INSTRUCTIONS

How to Use This Calculator

This calculator can be used in two modes:

MODE A: Single Avoidance Audit

Focus on one specific person, relationship, or decision you have been avoiding. Complete all five tax sections for that single avoidance. Add up the total Proximity Tax Score.

MODE B: Life Audit

Complete the calculator across your life broadly — all patterns, all relationships, all avoidances. This generates a Total Life Proximity Tax: the full accumulated cost of your avoidance architecture.

I am assessing (circle): **SINGLE AVOIDANCE / LIFE AUDIT**

If single avoidance — the person / situation I am calculating:

TAX CATEGORY 01

Opportunity Cost Tax

Score each dimension based on the opportunity value lost through emotional avoidance. Ask: what did I not access, not pursue, or not enter because of who was involved?

Score 0 = no cost in this area | Score 10 = significant, ongoing, measurable cost

COST TYPE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	SCORE	NOTES
Declined opportunity	Said no to a role, project, or deal because of who else was involved	/10	
Rejected collaboration	Did not pursue partnership or alliance due to interpersonal discomfort	/10	
Avoided industry presence	Stopped attending events, spaces, or circles to avoid someone	/10	
Missed introduction	Did not pursue or accept introductions due to association with triggering person	/10	
Career stagnation	Did not apply for, pursue, or accept positions due to proximity concerns	/10	
Business decision distortion	Made inferior strategic choices to avoid working with or near someone	/10	
OPPORTUNITY COST TAX TOTAL		TOTAL:	/

0–20 Low opportunity cost. Avoidance patterns have not significantly limited access.	21–40 Moderate cost. Specific opportunities have been lost to emotional avoidance.	41–60 High cost. Significant strategic contraction visible. Systematic avoidance architecture.
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The single most significant opportunity I lost to emotional avoidance:

TAX CATEGORY 02

Relationship Cost Tax

Score the network, leverage, and access you have surrendered through emotional withdrawal from relationships.

COST TYPE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	SCORE	NOTES
Network contraction	Circle of access has shrunk due to avoidances and exits	/10	
Mentor / sponsor loss	High-value advisor or sponsor relationship damaged or ended	/10	
Peer relationship loss	Lost peers of strategic value through withdrawal or conflict exits	/10	
Influence erosion	Reputation or influence damaged by how exits were executed	/10	
Alliance failure	Failed to build or maintain important alliances due to proximity discomfort	/10	
Information loss	No longer in rooms, conversations, or networks where critical intelligence circulates	/10	
Social capital decay	Relationships that once produced warm introductions have gone cold	/10	
RELATIONSHIP COST TAX TOTAL		TOTAL:	/

0–20 Network intact. Relationship exits have been selective and low-cost.	21–45 Noticeable network erosion. Key relationships compromised by avoidance patterns.	46–70 Significant isolation risk. Strategic network has contracted materially.
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The relationship loss that has cost me the most access or leverage:

TAX CATEGORY 03

Ego Cost Tax

Score the compounding strategic cost of choosing ego protection over strategic positioning. This is where the most hidden and most expensive costs accumulate.

COST TYPE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	SCORE	NOTES
Decision quality loss	Major decisions made from emotional state rather than strategic clarity	/10	
Feedback deprivation	Avoided or removed sources of honest, challenging feedback	/10	
Blind spot accumulation	Significant blind spots growing due to removal of challengers	/10	
Competitive intelligence loss	Avoiding rivals means not understanding them — costly in market	/10	
Status-over-value decisions	Chose inferior outcomes to protect status or avoid embarrassment	/10	
Emotional energy drain	Significant mental bandwidth consumed by maintaining avoidance architecture	/10	
Righteous momentum	Energy spent on moral justification instead of strategic action	/10	
EGO COST TAX TOTAL		TOTAL:	/

0–20 Ego is reasonably governed. Not significantly distorting major decisions.	21–45 Ego is a meaningful decision distortion factor. Specific areas need attention.	46–70 High ego capture. Significant decisions being made from protection, not strategy.
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The most expensive ego-protection decision I have made:

TAX CATEGORY 04

Withdrawal Consequence Tax

Score the operational, reputational, and relational cost of exits and withdrawals that have already occurred.

COST TYPE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	SCORE	NOTES
Reputation cost	Exits or conflicts have damaged how others perceive your reliability or character	/10	
Operational disruption	Exits created gaps, chaos, or damage to operations or projects	/10	
Relationship bridge burning	Exits closed doors to people, networks, or industries permanently	/10	
Momentum loss	Withdrawals interrupted important progress, projects, or trajectories	/10	
Loyalty signal damage	Pattern of exits has made others reluctant to invest in relationship with you	/10	
Unfinished business cost	Unresolved exits still create emotional drag or unfinished strategic exposure	/10	
WITHDRAWAL CONSEQUENCE TAX TOTAL		TOTAL:	/

0–20 Exits have been clean. Withdrawal consequences minimal.	21–35 Moderate consequence accumulation. Some exits have left lasting strategic damage.	36–60 High withdrawal consequence profile. Exit pattern is now a reputational and strategic liability.
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TAX CATEGORY 05

Strategic Range Tax

Score the contraction of your total strategic freedom — the rooms, possibilities, relationships, and territory that are no longer accessible because of your avoidance architecture.

COST TYPE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	SCORE	NOTES
Territory contraction	Geographic, industry, or social spaces now off-limits due to who is there	/10	
Possibility filtering	Certain types of opportunities are automatically dismissed based on avoidance patterns	/10	
Decision velocity loss	Decision-making is slower because emotional screening precedes strategic analysis	/10	
Creative range limitation	Collaboration possibilities reduced by avoidance of challenging thinking partners	/10	
Reaction dependency	Choices increasingly defined by what you are moving away from rather than toward	/10	
Freedom illusion	Feel free while operating inside an invisible fence built by your avoidances	/10	
Future option foreclosure	Avoidance patterns are actively closing doors that will not reopen easily	/10	
STRATEGIC RANGE TAX TOTAL		TOTAL:	/

0–20 Strategic range largely intact. Freedom of movement preserved.	21–45 Meaningful range contraction. Specific territories or possibilities inaccessible.	46–70 Significant strategic containment. Movement is heavily patterned around avoidance.
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TOTAL CALCULATION

Your Total Proximity Tax Score

Transfer your totals from each category to calculate your complete Proximity Tax.

TAX CATEGORY	MAX	YOUR SCORE
Tax 01: Opportunity Cost Tax	60	/ ____
Tax 02: Relationship Cost Tax	70	/ ____
Tax 03: Ego Cost Tax	70	/ ____
Tax 04: Withdrawal Consequence Tax	60	/ ____
Tax 05: Strategic Range Tax	70	/ ____
TOTAL PROXIMITY TAX SCORE	330	/330

Score Interpretation

0–80: Low Tax

Avoidance patterns present but cost is manageable. Build governance proactively.

81–165: Moderate Tax

Meaningful strategic cost accumulating. Targeted audit of highest-scoring categories recommended.

166–250: High Tax

Significant strategic and relational damage in progress. Avoidance architecture is now a primary strategic liability.

251–330: Critical Tax

Full-scale strategic contraction. Emotional governance is now an existential business and life priority.

RECLAMATION PLAN

The Proximity Tax Reduction Plan

A high Proximity Tax score is not a verdict — it is a calculation. Every score can be reduced through deliberate emotional governance. This page is your reduction architecture.

"Emotional relief is often financially expensive. You just aren't looking at the receipt."

The Highest-Cost Identification

My three highest-cost avoidances (the ones generating the largest tax):

The Reduction Priorities

AVOIDANCE	TAX REDUCTION ACTION	TIMELINE

The 90-Day Commitment

In the next 90 days, I commit to reclaiming the following strategic territory:

The specific first action I will take in the next 7 days to begin reducing my Proximity Tax:

The Invoice Audit

What is the total life cost, in honest terms, of your avoidance architecture? Not just strategically — in identity, range, and freedom. Write the honest, full invoice.

The Reclamation Vision

Describe the version of your life, relationships, and strategic position that would be possible if your Proximity Tax were reduced to near zero. What rooms would you be in? What relationships would exist? What would you be building?

"Emotional relief is real. So is the invoice. The question is which one you read more carefully."



M I N D A N C H O R

by Jai

This toolkit is the most shareable asset in the ProximityOS Ecosystem.
Share it. The invoice others have never opened may change what they build next.
